

APPENDIX

Method and limits

How the numbers in our mall reports are produced, what they mean and what they do not claim. Written for analysts, legal teams and anyone who wants to check our work.

METHOD

What we count

An **entry** is a valid pass into the measured area through an instrumented entrance. We count entries, not unique people: we never recognize anyone, so a visitor who leaves and comes back is counted again. Staff are filtered out.

What we describe

88+ visual attributes per visit, from a vocabulary of 450+ detectable details: age band, how people present (style, brands worn), who they came with and what they carry. Children with adults are recorded as part of the group.

How audiences are built

A segmentation model groups visits with similar attributes into distinct **personas**. The number of personas comes from the data of each center. Names and avatars are descriptive labels, and avatars are illustrative.

Time patterns

Visits per day by weekday and weekend, and the share of each audience's visits by hour. Weekend effects compare average visits per day, not totals.

Purchase signal

The share of visits that end with a **visible purchase**: a shopping bag, cart, basket, box or parcel. Personal bags are excluded. It is measured on a sample of analyzed visits.

Purchase categories

Read from bags and packaging with a **readable logo**. Only about one bag in ten carries one, so categories are directional: we read the trend, not an exact number.

PRIVACY

All analysis runs without facial recognition or biometric templates. Visits cannot be linked or re-identified. All outputs are aggregated (minimum 25 persons per segment). Age estimation uses bands with error tolerances, and "unknown" is reported as a value, never reallocated.

LIMITS WE STATE UP FRONT

- **One center is one center.** A case study describes a single shopping center. It is not a market average or a benchmark for other centers.
- **Compare like with like.** Comparisons between centers need the same method, similar camera placement and comparable periods. Holidays, weather and events move the patterns.
- **Shares are more robust than totals.** We lead with distributions and patterns. Absolute counts depend on how many entrances are instrumented and where the cameras sit.
- **Age is an estimate.** We report decade bands with an error tolerance, never an exact age and never an age check.
- **The purchase signal is visual.** It shows that a visit ended with something bought, not what it cost, and only a readable logo shows where it came from.
- **Entrance cameras see entrances.** They do not follow visitors through the center and do not measure dwell time or paths.